

DRAFT FOR MEDICAL REVIEW — NOT PUBLISHED

This article is written but **not live**, and is not linked from anywhere on the site. It cannot publish until a reviewing clinician is named: the build refuses an article marked `clinical` with no named reviewer, which is why this page exists rather than a live URL. Please read it as the page a donor will see, mark anything that is wrong or that you would word differently, and complete the sign-off on the last page.

Who can donate blood

The age and haemoglobin limits, the conditions that rule someone out permanently, and the temporary reasons you may be asked to come back later.

Intended URL	https://raktify.choudhari.ngo/learn/who-can-donate-blood
Written by	Choudhari EduHealth India Foundation
Status	draft (clinical)
Reviewer	none named — this is what is being requested

Specific questions for the reviewer

- **The minimum donor weight is deliberately not printed on this page.** No weight is stated anywhere in the Raktify platform - not in the eligibility reference data, not as a database constraint - so there is no signed figure to quote. Should a figure be published, and if so what is it?
- The age band and the haemoglobin floor are taken from Raktify's own reference data, signed on 10 July 2026. Please confirm both are correct to state publicly, in these words, to a lay reader.
- The permanent and temporary exclusion lists come from the same signed reference data. Please confirm nothing is missing, and nothing is stated more absolutely than you would state it.
- The page says explicitly that it is not a clearance and that only the blood bank's medical officer decides on the day. Is that framing strong enough?

The article, as it will publish

Most healthy adults can give blood, and most people who think they cannot actually can. The checks below exist to protect two people at once: the patient who receives the unit, and the donor sitting in the chair.

Nothing on this page is a clearance. The only assessment that counts is the one the blood bank's own medical officer makes on the day, after seeing you and reading your answers. Raktify's registration asks the same questions in advance so that you are not travelling to a camp for nothing — it is a filter, not a decision.

The two numbers that are checked every time

Age: 18 to 65. Raktify will not accept a registration outside that band at all; it is enforced in the database rather than in a form, because an age that slips through is not a cosmetic error.

Haemoglobin: at least 12.5 g/dL, for men and women alike. This is measured from a fingerprick on the day, not taken on trust, and it is the single most common reason an otherwise willing donor is turned away. A low reading is not a verdict on your health — haemoglobin moves with diet, hydration, recent illness and menstruation — and being deferred once says nothing about the next time.

Your weight is also checked at the chair, against a minimum the blood bank applies. This page deliberately prints no figure for it, because the number in use belongs to the blood bank's own protocol rather than to a web page.

What rules someone out permanently

These are the conditions where the answer does not change with time. If any of them applies to you, blood donation is not the way you can help — and there is no stigma in it, because the same list protects both you and a stranger who cannot choose what they are given.

- A positive test, at any point, for **HIV, hepatitis B or hepatitis C**.
- A **history of cancer**. There is no disease-free exception; the fact of the

history is the exclusion.

- **Heart disease, diabetes that requires insulin**, or ****epilepsy** that is

being treated with medication**.

- **Haemophilia or any bleeding disorder**.
- **Pregnancy, or breastfeeding within twelve months of giving birth**. This one

is temporary in the ordinary sense of the word — it passes — but while it applies it is absolute.

- **Ever having injected recreational drugs**.
- **A major organ transplant**.
- **Any chronic infectious illness** you have been told you have.

Two of these are commonly misreported elsewhere, so they are worth stating plainly. There is **no** window after which a cancer history stops counting. And epilepsy on medication is an exclusion for everyone, not only for people whose seizures are poorly controlled.

What means "not today" rather than "not ever"

A temporary deferral is a wait, and the wait is usually short. Each one below carries the minimum period that applies.

If this is true	Come back after
You have drunk alcohol in the last 48 hours	2 days
You have had fever, a cold or flu	7 days, and only once symptoms have fully gone
You have had a tattoo or piercing	180 days
You have had a live vaccine — MMR, oral polio, yellow fever	28 days
You have had any other vaccine — tetanus, flu, COVID	14 days
You have had a tooth extraction or major dental work	14 days
You have had surgery	90 days
You are on antibiotics	14 days
You are taking any prescription medicine	the blood bank will review it with you
You donated whole blood recently	90 days for men, 120 days for women

These are floors, not fixed terms. The blood bank may ask for longer once it knows the specifics — which drug, which vaccine, how extensive the surgery — and that judgement sits with the medical officer, not with this table. A deferral that is longer than the number above is not an error.

Prescription medicine is the one row with no number, deliberately. Most everyday medicines do not stop you donating; a few do; and which is which depends on the drug and on why you are taking it. Bring the name of it with you.

Things that are not reasons

A great deal of folklore keeps willing donors away. None of the following is, by itself, a reason you cannot donate:

- being a woman, or being on your period
- being vegetarian
- being over 50, as long as you are within the age band and otherwise well
- having donated at a camp before rather than at a blood bank
- not knowing your blood group — the blood bank will establish it
- being nervous about needles, which the staff deal with all day

The pre-screen on Raktify, and what it does with your answers

When you register, Raktify asks you the questions above. A permanent exclusion means we will not send you donor alerts, because an alert you cannot act on is only a disappointment. A temporary deferral sets a date after which alerts resume.

Those answers steer the messages you receive. They are not a medical record, they are not shared with hospitals, and they never override the blood bank. If you answer the pre-screen one way and the doctor at the camp reaches a different conclusion, the doctor is right and the system is the thing that was out of date.

If you are unsure about an answer, register anyway and raise it at the chair. The people there assess donors all day and would far rather have the conversation than lose a donor to a guess.

Sources

- National Blood Transfusion Council (NBTC), Standards for Blood Banks and Blood Transfusion Services
- Raktify donor eligibility reference data, confirmed by the foundation's medical advisor on 10 July 2026

Reviewer sign-off

Raktify records the reviewing clinician by name on the published page, with the review date. Nothing below is optional — an unnamed review cannot be recorded.

Full name

Qualification (e.g. MD Pathology / MD Transfusion Medicine)

Medical council registration number

Verdict

- ☐ Approved as written.
- ☐ Approved with the amendments I have marked on this document.
- ☐ Not approved — see my notes.

Review date

Next review due (we default to 12 months unless you say otherwise)

Signature

Returned sign-offs are filed in docs/medical-review/ alongside the reference-data review of 10 July 2026, and the reviewer name is published on the article itself.